Army of Three

Posted originally on the Archive of Our Own at http://archiveofourown.org/works/64623856.

Rating:
Teen And Up Audiences

Archive Warning:
No Archive Warnings Apply

Categories:
M/M, Other

Fandoms:
She-Ra and the Princesses of Power (2018), She-Ra: Princess Of Power (1985)

Relationship:
Kyle/Lonnie/Rogelio (She-Ra)

Characters:
Rogelio (She-Ra), Kyle (She-Ra), Lonnie (She-Ra), Imp (She-Ra)

Additional Tags:
Domestic Fluff, Awkward Romance, Fluff and Hurt/Comfort, Polyamory, Team as Family, Idiots in Love, Post-Canon, Lonnie represses her feelings to an unhealthy degree, Foreshadowing, Childhood Trauma, Rogelio is a gentle soul (She-Ra), Post-War, Slice of Life, Family Feels, Kyle loves being a parent (She Ra), Crimson Waste (She-Ra)

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Part 2 of Breaking Free from Prophecy

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by Sapphiredixon2020

Summary

Lonnie snorted. “Yeah, well, I guess that makes one of us.”

“You like it here,” Kyle said, not even looking her way as he scratched under Imp’s chin. “You haven’t yelled at me in like three days.”

Rogelio’s chest moved with a deep sound that might’ve been a chuckle.

Lonnie didn’t respond right away. She looked out over the wastes, not really focusing on anything. The sharp rocks, the red dust, the pieces of old machinery rusting into the ground. She was still not used to how peaceful it was here, in the middle of all this destruction. The war was over, and despite everything that had happened, they had made it through. They had survived. Together.

_____

After hearing that the war has ended, Lonnie, Rogelio, and Kyle seek a fresh start in the Crimson Waste. They find happiness in adopting a baby creature named Imp, but while Rogelio and Kyle manage to move on from their past childhood traumas, Lonnie struggles. The mental scars of war still haunt her, leaving her constantly on edge and unsure of how to let her guard down. As she grapples with finding a new purpose beyond her former life in the military.

Notes

Hi guys, this one-shot takes place in Chapter 2 in my series in the first book, which can be read on its own, but if you want to understand the context, then check out my series if you want. This one-shot focuses on the three horde characters that, unfortunately, did not get nearly enough screen time in

the show. Also, this chapter mainly focuses on Lonnie and adds some clues to some of the border plot points that will be occurring in the series in the future. Hope you enjoy the chapter:)

I still can't believe that originally Lonnie was meant to be She ra well, her design was meant to be her. I am so glad that they at least managed to recycle her and create a whole new character, though:)

The Crimson Waste stretched out in all directions, sharp ridges and red stone rising like the ribs of some great beast, long dead and buried. Dust rolled low across the dry ground as the three of them made a pit stop since Kyle was jabbering on about the creature being restless. Much to Lonnie's frustration. “Seriously, Kyle, I thought we already had our hands full just dealing with your mollycoddling ass. Never mind the gimp you attach us with.”

She watched Kyle scoop Imp up and place him on the ground. The little creature didn’t waste a second before waddling around his surroundings, twitchy and aimless. Kyle didn’t say anything at first. He just tugged at the straps around his waist with a snivel, peeling off the baby pouch like it had been fused to his skin. His fingers fumbled once as the pouch dropped to the ground, as he finally answered her. “Hey, that’s mean. What if he understood? We don’t want him using that kind of language when he gets older. And come on, Lonnie, if we do not stop for a break, we will regret it.”

She could not help but huff and place her hand on her face. “Ugh, fine, whatever.”

Kyle then rushes into the ground, where he sits in the sand, knees tucked awkwardly to his chest and his sleeves pushed up to his elbows. His face was streaked with smudges from the dust, but his grin stretched wide as Imp scuttled before him, wings twitching in short bursts as it darted around like a tiny gremlin on a sugar high. Kyle let out a loud, jittery laugh when Imp pounced on a rock like it was the final boss of some long-forgotten game.

"You're gonna wear yourself out," Kyle warned, but there was no real concern in his voice. Just delight, open and unguarded. Imp released a shrill squeal in response, then zipped upward, swerving close to Kyle’s head. Kyle flinched, arms flailing, but still laughed. “Hey! No fair! I don’t have wings!”

Lonnie stood a few feet away. Her posture was casual, but her eyes tracked both of them, Imp’s darting form and Kyle’s chaotic

movements. Her mouth tugged into a rare, uneven smile, something softer than usual, though her eyebrows still pinched like she wasn’t quite ready to let her guard down all the way.

Rogelio stood behind her, tall and still. His shadow stretched past hers, and when he stepped closer, the dust barely stirred beneath his feet. He made a sound low and rough but not harsh. Lonnie didn't turn. She didn’t need to. She recognized the sound, the way it rose from deep in his chest. She knew he was asking her if she was okay.

He settled thick arms around her waist.

Lonnie went rigid.

Her shoulders locked, her hands curled slightly. For a second, she had the urge to elbow him in the ribs and storm off. Her jaw tightened, and her eyes narrowed. Then she dispersed air through her nose, and it was like something inside her shifted. Just a small roll of her shoulder, the easing of tension in her stance. She didn’t move away.

Rogelio didn’t say anything. He just stayed like that, arms wrapped around her, watching Kyle try to chase Imp in lazy circles. Dust kicked up around the boy’s shoes, and his laughter blared against the rock.

"I thought that thing would fly off the first chance he got," Lonnie said finally. Her voice was rough.

Kyle looked up, hair sticking to his forehead. “Nah. Imp likes it here. Right, buddy?”

Imp made a series of clicks that could’ve meant anything. It skittered up Kyle’s arm, claws gently catching on the fabric, then perched on his shoulder and nudged his face with its snout.

Lonnie snorted. “Yeah, well, I guess that makes one of us.”

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She leaned slightly into Rogelio’s arms, just enough to show she didn’t mind the contact.

Kyle let himself fall backwards into the dust with a loud sigh, arms spread wide, Imp still clinging to his shoulder like a cape that refused to detach.

“I’m never going back,” he said, staring up at the washed-out sky. “I don’t care if I have to sleep in the sand forever.”

“You’ll change your mind the first time something crawls into your boots,” Lonnie said in amusement.

Imp made a clicking sound and leapt off Kyle, racing off again. Kyle scrambled up to follow him, letting out a battle cry that was more squeak than roar.

Lonnie let her smile stretch just a little further. Rogelio’s hands loosened their hold, and the sudden absence of his touch was immediate, a quiet shift in the air. Her eyes followed him as he moved toward Kyle, who was still chasing after Imp. He stopped right in front of him, blocking his path. Rogelio bent down, and for a moment, Lonnie couldn’t look away as he brushed his mouth that curved slightly over Kyle’s lips with a quiet roughness, a mix of animal instinct and careful control with so much affection.

Kyle made a loud slurp sound in the kiss as Rogelio caressed his lips with dainty and soft movements despite his massive frame. Kyle looked like he might faint from sheer shock, his hands flying up to cradle Rogelio's scales, fingers glided over his skin. Rogelio gave a low, pleased sound at the touch. The gesture was sickeningly cute. It made something in Lonnie freeze. A pill drop slid into her thoughts.

Her two boys separated from the kiss. Rogelio gently rubbed Kyle's cheek with his hand, then moved up to gently tousle his blond hair. Kyle gave Rogelio that dumb, dopey look, his face turning bright red as he looked up at him and beamed even wider. "What was that for?" The big guy rumbles in response and hugs Kyle in a soft nest, securing him. Imp scampered up to them and leapt onto both of them as his stubbly little hands reached around them to join the embrace.

Kyle let out short bursts of laughter, clearly unable to stop himself, while Rogelio let out a sound that sounded in between a growl and laughter as the three of them huddled together despite the fact that it was boiling hot out here.

Lonnie could not help but roll her eyes at the three of them as she watched them when Kyle wiggled out of the hug and pulled her forcefully into it. "Hey, you, too, don't just stand there." He said in excitement.

Lonnie in the middle, her arms trapped between them, her breath coming in short gasps. She scowled, her face pinched as she squirmed a little. "For fuck's sake, Kyle," she grunted, her voice muffled by the pressure. "Now I can't breathe." She gave a sharp push, trying to pry herself free, but they only held onto her. For a moment, panic surged.

She hated feeling trapped like this. It reminded her too much of how she'd felt all those years ago as a little girl alone who had to make a desperate choice that had stolen her innocence, her childhood forever. A memory flashes into her mind like poison. *Lonnie, don't leave, please. I am sorry…I was only trying to help…*

I need you. She blicked the memory away and could not help but finally give in to the overwhelming sensation of relief that she no longer had to be strong anymore. Tears began to slip down her face, each one trailing quietly until they landed on Kyle. He pressed in closer to her. Lonnie felt whole as Kyle enveloped her while Rogelio kissed her hair. Above them, Imp leaned down, his small form nuzzling her cheek in a comforting gesture. Lonnie allowed a soft smile to tug at her lips as she huddled into them.

The hug lasted a full five minutes before Lonnie stepped back, detangling herself reality setting back in. She began marching off across the sand. She knew they couldn't afford to waste any more time. "Alright, enough dilly-dallying. We better keep moving. Huntara still has those jobs lined up for us."

Kyle sighed. "Fine, just let me feed Imp before we head out." He released both Rogelio and the baby creature, lifting Imp from Rogelio's shoulder. Cradling him before, he set him gently on the ground, then crouched to go through the pouch. He pulled out a bottle and began feeding Imp.

Rogelio picked up the pouch, slinging the strap across his belly. He let out a deep rumble, clearly indicating he'd carry the baby next. Kyle smiled and passed Imp over. Rogelio took the little creature and tucked him carefully into the pouch.

Her eyes gave them a long, dead-eyed stare as she stayed put with one arm on her hip. "Everyone ready now?"

Rogelio let out a low, annoyed grunt and waved his hands in a flurry of gestures. The meaning was clear: *Why are you being so impatient and snappy? We've got plenty of time. No need to take it out on us. What's your deal, anyway? You didn't even want to travel back to Bright Moon for the party after Horde Prime was defeated. Everyone else did. Everyone else celebrated.*

Lonnie snapped, completely losing her cool. “Oh, please. Then you’re more naive than Kyle, maybe worse, and that’s saying something.”

“Hey.” Kyle shot out, offended, with a frown.

She bypassed him as her voice rose. “We’re outcasts! Did you forget that? Just a bunch of defected Horde soldiers. We don’t get some magic sword and literary become a giant princess through some sparkly transformation. We don’t get the luxury of a warm welcome. And don’t even start on Catra. After everything she’s done, she gets a free pass? Because of love? Because the person who abandoned us decided she’s worth saving?” Her voice cracked with fury as her arm waved between the three of them. “We grew up with them. We were the ones stuck with Catra’s tantrums and obsessions. We took every damn order, every insult, every threat she threw our way. Nearly breaking our backs. Did we ever hear a ‘good job’? From her? From Shadow Weaver? From Hordak? Hell no!” She turned away, her face away and closed her eyes. Her voice became a whisper. “And now Catra gets to be happy. Gets to be forgiven. It’s pathetic. So yeah, I’d rather forget that part of my life. I’d rather keep moving. And I sure as hell don’t want to sit around pretending that everything is fucking forgotten. It is insulting to us to even do that.”

Kyle spoke quietly. “Lonnie, you're right. The Horde was awful. I hated it there. It was a hellhole living in fear every day, always watching my back. I was angry too when Adora left without us. I think we all were. But even then, I knew the Horde was messed up. And if she had come back for us... I would’ve voted to leave. I would’ve begged you two to come with me. But that didn’t happen. And yeah, Catra made everything worse. She treated us like dirt. But none of that matters anymore. Not really.” He glanced at Rogelio, then back at her. “I’ve got my family now. That’s you two. And Imp. The war’s over. We don’t have to carry all that weight with us anymore. We’re free. Let’s just be happy, okay?”

Her amber eyes met his baby-brown eyes as his words stirred something in her chest. *Why did Kyle have to have slim moments of fucking wisdom? Why wasn't she allowed to feel bitter about how unfair life had dealt them? They were just kids who were not allowed to be dumb about things; they were chained into adulthood at the age of 7.* Still, she couldn't lash out at them; they didn't deserve that from her, even though there had been times when she just wanted to shake them and scream at them, *why not?* But she knew that the two had the sweetest hearts and would forgive anyone without a reason, especially Kyle.

She opened her mouth and said softly. "Sorry, I just don't know how to move forward without being assigned to a job or a mission. I guess I don't really know how to relax."

Rogelio's eyes softened, making a soothing noise to let her know it was okay. Kyle smiled and walked toward her. "Then we'll figure it out together, right?" he said. That's when Imp decided to make his presence known, chirping in agreement. Lonnie shook her head, then took Kyle's hand, offering a small smile. "Right." Kyle beamed at her as the three of them started walking through the sand.

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